Order Tubulidentata, Family Orycteropodidae, Genus *Orycteropus*

The solitary, semi-fossorial, nocturnal aardvarks (*Orycteropus afer* 50-80 kg) subsist on ants and termites in Africa south of the Sahara. Although not easily classified, the placenta (280 g, n1, 2787) is predominantly zonary and endotheliochorial (2391, 2396, 2397, 7563, 7566, 10310, 10690, 10961, 11109) and implants into a bicornuate (10961) or duplex (10690, 11109) uterus. Neonates are naked with open eyes (2787, 5219, 9947). Breeding may be initiated by rain because floods concentrate animals on high ground (5758). Males are ascrotal and have a short penis (281a). Details of anatomy (11109) and milk composition (5822, 11635) are available.

NEONATAL MASS		
Orycteropus afer	1-2 kg	2384
	1.8-2 kg	9947
	1.87 kg; n1	9454
NEONATAL SIZE		
Orycteropus afer	TL: ~550 mm	9947
WEANING MASS		
Orycteropus afer	3.5 kg, 1 mo	9947
	9 kg, 3 mo	9947
WEANING SIZE		
Orycteropus afer	TL: 680 mm, 1 mo	9947
	TL: 930 mm, 3 mo	9947
LITTER SIZE		
Orycteropus afer	1	3865
	1	5277
	1	11109
	1; 2 rare	2384, 11046, 11253
	1 emb; n1 f	10154
	1 ea; n4 lt	5219
	1.2 yg; r1-2; n5 lt, 1 f	2787
SEXUAL MATURITY		
Orycteropus afer	f: 1st birth: 3 yr; n1	3865
GESTATION		
Orycteropus afer	est 7 mo	2384, 7196, 7361
	252.5 d; r221-282; dropped 53, 110 d gests	5219
LACTATION		
Orycteropus afer	leave nest: ~2 wk	11046
	den emergence: 3rd wk	11253
	solid food: 3 wk	4354a
	solid food: 3 mo	7196
LITTERS/YEAR		
Orycteropus afer	1	11253
SEASONALITY		
Orycteropus afer	mate: Apr-May; native guides; Ruwenzori Mt, e Africa	7361
	mate: end Apr-May; Zaire	11253
	mate: May-?; Zaire	11046
	birth: May-June; Ethiopia	9947
	birth: May-July; S Africa	9947
	birth: May-Aug; s Africa	10153
	birth: Oct-Nov; Zaire	11253
	birth: Oct-Nov; native guides; Ruwenzori Mt, e Africa	7361
	birth: early Nov; Uganda	5758